Story Summary Quiz — Somebody, Wanted, But, So, Then

Name: _____ Date: _____

Story 1: The Missing Library Book

Maya wanted to return her favorite mystery book before the library closed on Friday. When she checked her backpack after school, the book was missing. She remembered reading it during lunch, so she retraced her steps to the cafeteria. The lunchroom was already empty, but a custodian pointed her toward the lost-and-found shelf. Maya found the book underneath a blue sweater and hurried to the library. She returned it with only five minutes to spare.

Directions: Complete each part using details from the story. Write in complete phrases or sentences.

Somebody:

Wanted:

But (problem):

So (what did they do):

Then (what happened after):

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Story 2: A Garden Surprise

Ethan hoped to grow tomatoes for his grandmother, who loved making homemade soup. He planted seeds in a sunny corner of the yard and watered them every afternoon. After two weeks, nothing had sprouted. Ethan discovered that the soil had become hard and dry beneath the surface. He mixed in compost, loosened the soil, and began checking the moisture each morning. Soon tiny green shoots appeared. By summer, he had enough ripe tomatoes to fill a basket for his grandmother.

Directions: Complete each part using details from the story. Write in complete phrases or sentences.

Somebody:

Wanted:

But (problem):

So (what did they do):

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Story 3: The Science Fair Mix-Up

Nina had spent a month building a model of a wind-powered car for the school science fair. On presentation day, she opened her box and discovered that one wheel had broken during the bus ride. The judges would arrive in twenty minutes. Instead of giving up, Nina borrowed tape and a spare bottle cap from another student. She carefully repaired the axle and tested the car on the classroom floor. It rolled farther than she expected. The judges praised her explanation of how she solved the problem.

Directions: Complete each part using details from the story. Write in complete phrases or sentences.

Somebody:

Wanted:

But (problem):

So (what did they do):

Then (what happened after):

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Story 4: The Rainy-Day Concert

Leo and his friends planned to perform music at the neighborhood park to raise money for an animal shelter. They had practiced their songs for weeks. Just as the audience began arriving, heavy rain started falling. The outdoor stage was too wet to use safely. Leo asked the community-center manager whether they could move inside. With help from several parents, the group carried their instruments into the hall and posted signs directing visitors to the new location. The concert started late but still raised enough money to buy food for the shelter.

Directions: Complete each part using details from the story. Write in complete phrases or sentences.

Somebody:

Wanted:

But (problem):

So (what did they do):

Then (what happened after):

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Story 5: The Forgotten Recipe

Ava promised to bake her grandfather’s favorite bread for his birthday. When she began mixing the ingredients, she realized the recipe card had disappeared. She could remember most of the steps, but not how much flour to use. She called her aunt, who had baked the bread with Grandfather many times. Her aunt explained the measurements and suggested letting the dough rise longer on the cool afternoon. Ava followed the advice, and the bread came out golden and soft. Her grandfather smiled when he tasted the familiar flavor.

Directions: Complete each part using details from the story. Write in complete phrases or sentences.

Somebody:

Wanted:

But (problem):

So (what did they do):

Then (what happened after):

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Story 6: The Team’s Second Chance

Marcus wanted his soccer team to reach the final match of a weekend tournament. During their first game, his team kept rushing toward the goal and leaving their defense open. They lost by two points. Before the next game, Marcus suggested that the players communicate more and stay in their assigned positions. The team practiced the new plan during their break. In the following match, they defended carefully and passed the ball to one another. They won the game and earned a place in the final.

Directions: Complete each part using details from the story. Write in complete phrases or sentences.

Somebody:

Wanted:

But (problem):

So (what did they do):

Then (what happened after):

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Story 7: The Stray Kitten

On her way home, Priya heard a faint meow coming from behind a closed garden gate. She wanted to help the kitten, but the gate was locked and she could not reach it. She knocked on the nearest door and explained what she had heard. The homeowner opened the gate, and together they found a small kitten hiding under a flowerpot. Priya's family took it to a veterinarian, who found that it was healthy but had no identification. After they posted notices around the neighborhood, the kitten's relieved owner came to collect it.

Directions: Complete each part using details from the story. Write in complete phrases or sentences.

Somebody:

Wanted:

But (problem):

So (what did they do):

Then (what happened after):

Answer Key — Sample Responses

1. The Missing Library Book

Somebody: Maya

Wanted: Return her library book before closing

But: She could not find the book in her backpack

So: She searched the cafeteria and checked lost and found

Then: She found and returned the book just in time

2. A Garden Surprise

Somebody: Ethan

Wanted: Grow tomatoes for his grandmother

But: His seeds were not sprouting in the dry, hard soil

So: He improved the soil and checked its moisture

Then: His plants grew and he gave his grandmother tomatoes

3. The Science Fair Mix-Up

Somebody: Nina

Wanted: Present her wind-powered car at the science fair

But: A wheel broke before the judges arrived

So: She repaired it using borrowed supplies and tested it

Then: Her car worked and the judges praised her problem-solving

4. The Rainy-Day Concert

Somebody: Leo and his friends

Wanted: Perform a fundraiser concert for an animal shelter

But: Rain made the outdoor stage unsafe

So: They arranged to move the concert indoors

Then: They performed and raised money for shelter food

5. The Forgotten Recipe

Somebody: Ava

Wanted: Bake her grandfather’s favorite bread

But: She lost the recipe and forgot a measurement

So: She called her aunt and followed her directions

Then: She baked the bread and pleased her grandfather

6. The Team’s Second Chance

Somebody: Marcus and his soccer team

Wanted: Reach the tournament final

But: They lost a game because of poor teamwork and defense

So: They made and practiced a better team strategy

Then: They won their next match and reached the final

7. The Stray Kitten

Somebody: Priya

Wanted: Help a kitten she heard behind a gate

But: The gate was locked and she could not reach it

So: She asked the homeowner for help and helped locate the owner

Then: The kitten was reunited with its owner